

Smart Grocery Shopping List: The Diabetic Indian Kitchen

These should make up 50% of your plate. They are high in fiber, low in carbs, and prevent sugar spikes.

To cook diabetic-friendly meals, you don't need expensive imported superfoods. You just need to know exactly what to buy from your local *Sabzi Mandi* and *Kirana* store.

Print this list and take it with you on your next grocery run.

■ 1. Vegetables (Buy in Bulk)

These should make up 50% of your plate. They are high in fiber, low in carbs, and prevent sugar spikes.

BUY THESE:

- **Green Leafy:** Palak (Spinach), Methi (Fenugreek), Bathua, Sarson (Mustard Greens)
- **Gourds (The Magic Veggies):** Lauki (Bottle Gourd), Karela (Bitter Gourd - *excellent for blood sugar*), Turai (Ridge Gourd), Tinda
- **Cruciferous:** Patta Gobi (Cabbage), Phool Gobi (Cauliflower), Broccoli
- **Others:** Bhindi (Okra), Baingan (Eggplant), Capsicum (Shimla Mirch), Beans, Mushroom, Tomato, Onion, Garlic, Ginger.

AVOID/LIMIT THESE:

- Potatoes (Aloo) - *Massive sugar spike!*
- Sweet Potatoes (Shakarkandi) - *Better than Aloo, but still limit to small portions.*
- Beetroot & Carrots - *Eat raw in salads, avoid boiling them into mush.*

■ 2. Grains & Flours (Atta)

Refined carbs are the enemy. Switch to these slow-digesting, complex grains.

BUY THESE:

- **Flours:** Jowar Atta, Bajra Atta, Ragi Atta, Besan (Chickpea Flour), Sattu, Almond Flour.
- **HACK:** Make "Diabetic Atta" by mixing 50% Whole Wheat with 25% Besan and 25% Jowar.
- **Grains:** Quinoa, Dalia (Broken Wheat), Steel Cut Oats.
- **Rice Alternatives:** Brown Rice, Black/Red Rice, or Cauliflower Rice.

AVOID THESE COMPLETELY:

- Maida (Refined Flour) - *Acts like pure sugar in the blood.*
- White Rice - *High glycemic index.*
- Instant Oats - *Spikes sugar faster than regular regular oats.*
- White Bread, Kulchas, Naans.

■ 3. Proteins (The Stabilizers)

Protein slows down the digestion of carbs, preventing glucose spikes.

BUY THESE:

- **Vegetarian:** Paneer (Cottage Cheese), Tofu, Soya Chunks/Granules, Eggs.
- **Dals & Legumes:** Moong Dal (Green/Yellow), Masoor Dal, Rajma (Kidney Beans), Chole (Chickpeas), Kala Chana. *(Note: Dals contain carbs, so eat them with extra veggies).*
- **Non-Vegetarian:** Chicken breast, Fish (Rohu, Katla, Pomfret), Mutton (lean cuts, occasional).

■ 4. Fats & Oils (The Satiety Providers)

Healthy fats are crucial for brain health and keeping you full so you don't crave sugar.

BUY THESE:

- **Cooking Oils:** Mustard Oil (Kacchi Ghani), Cold-Pressed Coconut Oil, Olive Oil, Groundnut Oil.
- **Ghee:** Pure Desi Ghee (1-2 teaspoons a day is excellent for slowing down carb absorption).
- **Nuts & Seeds:** Almonds (Badam), Walnuts (Akhrot), Chia Seeds, Flax Seeds (Alsi), Pumpkin Seeds, Sunflower Seeds.

AVOID THESE COMPLETELY:

- Refined Vegetable Oils (Soybean, Sunflower, Canola) - *Highly inflammatory.*
- Margarine or "Diet Butter".
- Dalda / Vanaspati.

■ 5. Sweeteners & Snacks

When the cravings hit, be prepared.

BUY THESE:

- **Sweeteners:** Stevia drops/powder, Erythritol, Monk Fruit sweetener.
- **Snacks:** Roasted Makhana (Fox Nuts), Roasted Chana, Peanuts.
- **Fruits (Low GI):** Apples, Guava (Amrood), Papaya, Berries, Jamun (*excellent for diabetics*).

AVOID THESE COMPLETELY:

- White Sugar, Brown Sugar, Jaggery (Gud), Honey. *(Yes, even Gud and Honey spike blood sugar just as fast as white sugar!)*
- Biscuits (Even "Marie" or "Digestive" biscuits are full of Maida and sugar).
- Packaged Fruit Juices (Pure liquid sugar).
- Rusk, Namkeen, Bhujia.

■ The Golden Grocery Rule:

If it comes in a crinkly plastic packet and has more than 5 ingredients on the back, **put it back on the shelf.** Buy real, single-ingredient foods.